

Yujin Jo

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[Google Scholar](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

Location: Seoul, Republic of Korea | Expected Graduation: 02/2028

RESEARCH SUMMARY:

I am a Ph.D. student working on reliable and efficient foundation models, with a focus on multimodal LLMs and vision-language models. My research studies how foundation models acquire, preserve, and use knowledge under real-world constraints such as compute, latency, and memory. My recent work spans memory-free continual adaptation, efficient hallucination mitigation, and post-training and reinforcement learning for general-purpose VLMs.

EDUCATION:

Seoul National University, Seoul, Republic of Korea

Ph.D. Student in Data Science

Sep 2024 – Present

- Research Area: Reliable and efficient foundation models (Multimodal LLMs and VLMs)
- Advisor: Prof. Taesup Kim
- GPA: 4.20/4.3

M.S. in Data Science

Sep 2022 – Aug 2024

- M.S. Thesis: "Don't Put All Knowledge in One Basket: Group-wise Prompt Learning for Vision-Language Models"
- GPA: 4.06/4.3

KAIST (Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology), Daejeon, Republic of Korea

B.S. in Electrical Engineering

Feb 2012 – Feb 2018

PUBLICATIONS:

- [ICLR 2026] Memory-Free Continual Learning with Null Space Adaptation for Zero-Shot Vision-Language Models | Yujin Jo, Taesup Kim | [arXiv:2510.21175](#)
 - Proposed Null-Space Adaptation (NuSA-CL), a memory-free continual learning method that constrains updates to under-utilized null-space directions to preserve zero-shot VLM capabilities without replay or parameter growth.
- [CVPR 2026 Findings] Attention-space Contrastive Guidance for Efficient Hallucination Mitigation in LVLMs | Yujin Jo, Sangyoon Bae, Taesup Kim | [arXiv:2601.13707](#)
 - Proposed Attention-space Contrastive Guidance (ACG), a training-free single-pass attention-level guidance method that reduces LVLM hallucinations by contrasting vision-conditioned and text-only attention paths.
- [WACV 2025] Retaining and Enhancing Pre-trained Knowledge in Vision-Language Models with Prompt Ensembling | Donggeun Kim*, Yujin Jo*, Myungjoo Lee*, Taesup Kim (* equal contribution) | [arXiv:2412.07077](#)
 - Proposed an attention-isolated ensemble of learned prompt groups: train multiple prompt groups with group-wise attention masking to enforce diversity, then ensemble them at inference.

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE:

Research Intern, EXAONE Lab, LG AI Research

Mar 2026 – Present

- Working on post-training general-purpose vision-language models, focusing on reinforcement learning for visual reasoning, perception, grounding, chart/document understanding tasks.
- Investigating multi-objective interference in unified VLM RL, where heterogeneous task formats, reward functions, verifiers, and reasoning policies can conflict under joint optimization.
- Built diagnostic experiments and evaluation pipelines to compare single-task with joint-task training, tracking performance deltas, format consistency, response length, and verifier-level failure modes.

Graduate Researcher, LAAL, Seoul National University

Sep 2023 – Present

- Developed parameter-efficient adaptation methods for CLIP/VLMs, including LoRA and prompt learning, with evaluations on continual learning, transfer, ablation, and GPU-time efficiency.
- Proposed and evaluated training-free inference-time guidance methods for improving LVLM faithfulness and reducing hallucinations across LLaVA, MiniGPT-4, and Qwen-VL.

Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University

Mar 2023 – Dec 2025

- Designed assignments and exams, graded coursework, and provided technical support for graduate-level courses.
- Courses: Math and Statistics Foundations for Data Science (Spring 2023); Ethical Implications of AI (Spring 2025, Fall 2025).
- Received Outstanding Teaching Assistant recognition for Ethical Implications of AI (Fall 2025).

Journalist, Chosun Ilbo, Seoul, Republic of Korea

Dec 2018 – Aug 2022

- Covered technology, science, and social issues at one of South Korea's major national newspapers; interviewed domain experts and translated complex topics into accessible narratives for a broad audience.

HONORS AND AWARDS:

Lecture & Research Scholarship, Seoul National University

Spring 2023, Fall 2024

- Awarded to one graduate student per advisor per semester in Spring 2023, Fall 2024
- Full tuition waiver and stipend for research and teaching assistance

KAIST Presidential Fellowship

2012 - 2016

- Recognized for academic excellence and contributions to science and technology
- Received full scholarship for the exchange student program at INSA Toulouse (2016) and UC Berkeley (2012)

Talent Medal of Korea

Dec 2011

- Awarded by the President of the Republic of Korea to 100 outstanding young leaders annually

SKILLS:

- **Programming & DL Frameworks:** Python, C/C++, PyTorch, Hugging Face, veRL
- **Research Tools:** PEFT/LoRA, VLM evaluation, RL post-training pipelines
- **Languages:** Korean native; English fluent (TOEFL iBT 94, Mar 2023; IELTS 7.0, Feb 2026)